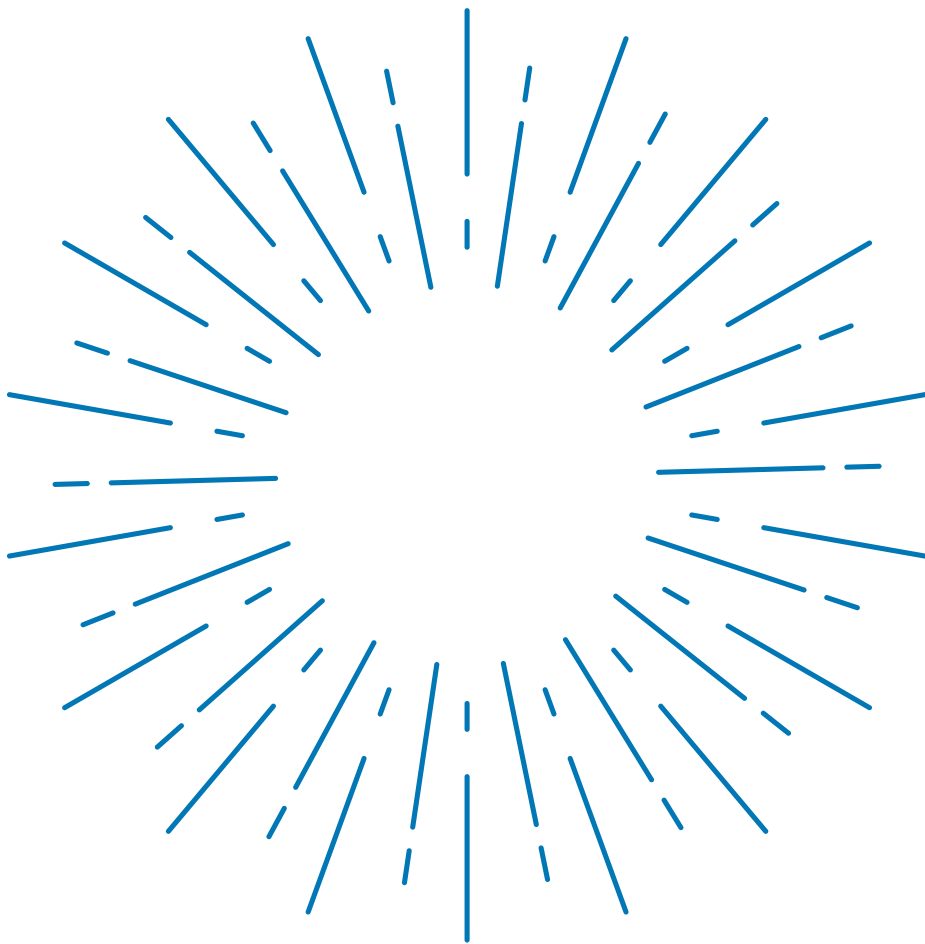
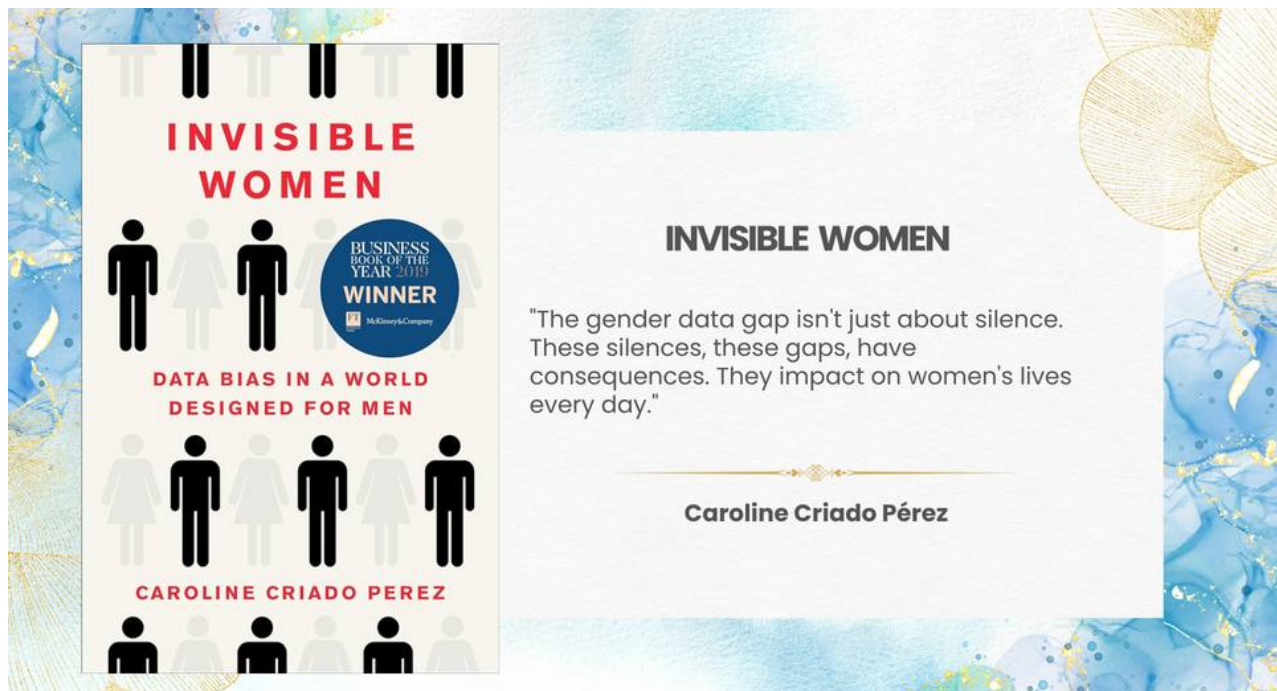


The Data Gap: Why Women Are Missing from the Equation



To all women reading this summary, have you ever felt like the world wasn't built for you?

Caroline Criado Pérez argues in "Invisible Women" that this is actually the case for most women. The book exposes a hidden bias: data and design based on the male experience as the default. This invisibility has real-world consequences, impacting everything from women's health to workplace safety.



Key Themes:

- **The Invisible Female Body:** Medical research, product design, and infrastructure often overlook the female body. This leads to everything from car crashes being more dangerous for women to ineffective medical treatments.
- **The Gender Data Gap:** Research focuses primarily on men, leaving a huge gap in our understanding of women's experiences. This perpetuates misconceptions and disadvantages women in areas like healthcare and the workplace.
- **Unpaid Care Work:** Women take on the lion's share of housework and caregiving, which goes unrecognized and undervalued. This burden limits their opportunities and reinforces gender stereotypes.

The Cost of Invisibility:

- **Health Risks:** Women receive misdiagnoses and inadequate treatments due to a lack of female-specific data.
- **Workplace Disadvantage:** Gender bias in hiring, promotion, and product design hinders women's professional success.
- **Safety Issues:** Public spaces and safety standards prioritize male bodies, putting women at risk.
- **Economic Inequality:** Unpaid care work is invisible in economic models, undervaluing women's contributions.



About the Author of Invisible Women

Invisible Women: Data Bias in a World Designed for Men was written by Caroline Criado Pérez—a British journalist, author, and women's rights activist. She was born in Brazil, raised in Saudi Arabia, Spain, and Portugal, before moving to the UK. She's best known for her advocacy to promote the representation of women in the public sphere, and successfully got a woman represented on a Bank of England note. For her advocacy and impact on public policy, she was awarded an OBE (Order of the British Empire) in 2015. Caroline continues to be an influential voice on gender equality and women's rights in the UK and beyond.

Quotes from the book

“The gender data gap isn't just about silence. These silences, these gaps, have consequences. They impact on women's lives every day.”

“Male bias just looks like common sense to them.”

“Instead of believing women when they say they're in pain, we tend to label them as mad.”

“There is no such thing as a woman who doesn't work. There is only a woman who isn't paid for her work.”

“Women's work, paid and unpaid, is the backbone of our society and our economy. It's about time we started valuing it.”

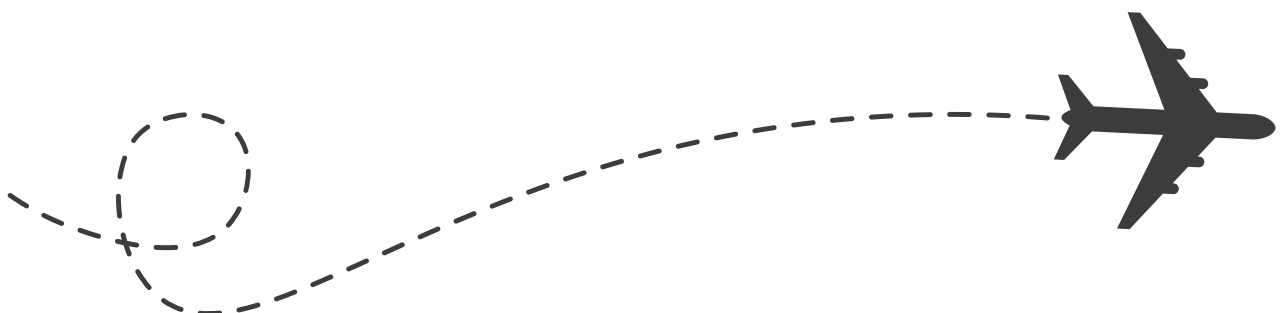
“Because male data makes up the majority of what we know, what is male comes to be seen as universal.”

“The male experience, the male perspective, has come to be seen as universal, while the female experience... is seen as...niche.”

“Women are not scaled-down men.”

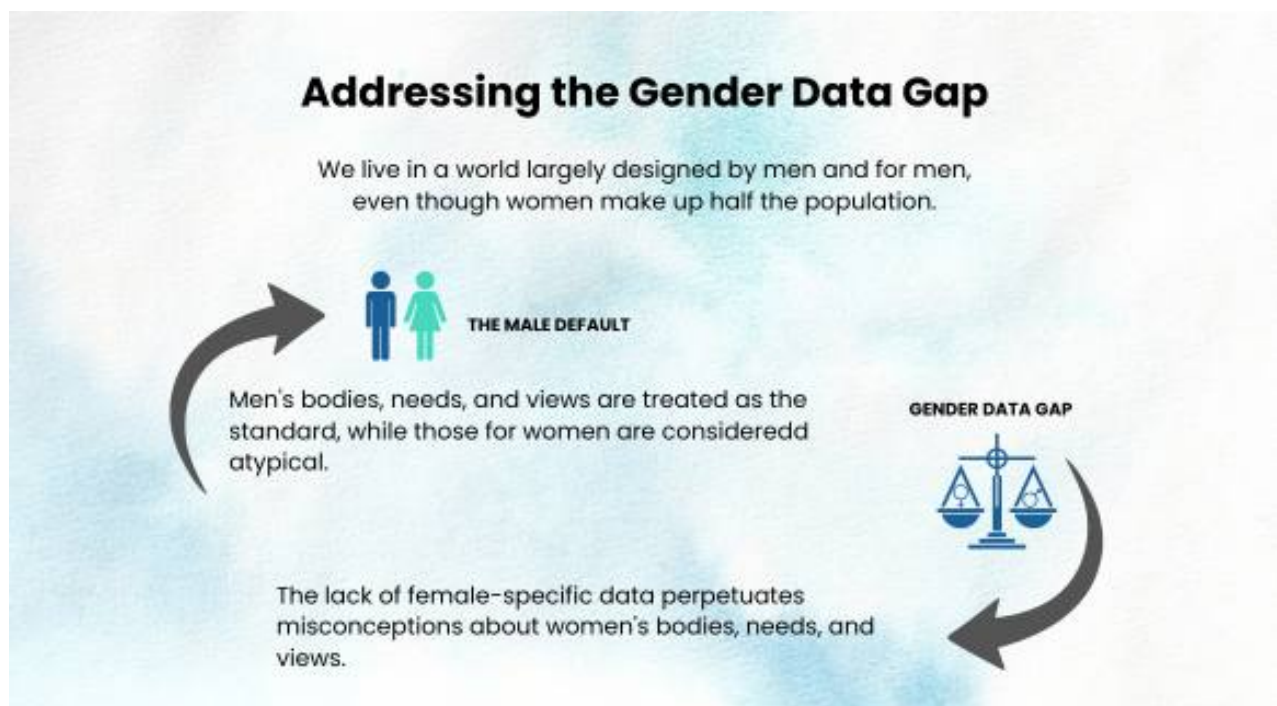
“It's not always easy to convince someone a need exists if they don't have that need themselves.”

“Bad data leads to bad resource allocation. And the data we have at the moment is incredibly bad.”



Questions to Ponder

- Can you think of examples from your own life where you've felt the effects of the "male default"?
- How can we challenge the idea that the male experience is universal?
- What changes can be made to ensure data collection is inclusive of all genders?



“The real reason we exclude women is because we see the rights of 50% of the population as a minority interest.”



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